

AAanalysis

v1.1 Cheat Sheet

Sequence → physicochemical scales → interpretable features → explainable ML → biological mechanism

[pip install aaanalysis](#) · [aaanalysis.readthedocs.io](#)

AAanalysis is a Python framework for interpretable, sequence-based protein prediction. It turns sequences into physicochemical features (CPP), trains explainable models, and traces every prediction back to a residue × property × group comparison — robust for small datasets. **v1.1** extends the core feature engine beyond physicochemical scales to PLM embeddings and protein structure.

Install · Import · Load

core + [pro]

```
# Python >= 3.11
pip install aaanalysis          # core
pip install 'aaanalysis[pro]'  # SHAP, FIMO, Bio
```

```
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import aaanalysis as aa
df_seq = aa.load_dataset(name='DOM_GSEC') # γ-secretase
labels = df_seq['label'].to_list()
df_scales = aa.load_scales()
```

The Golden Workflow

canonical pipeline

- LOAD** load_dataset · load_scales → df_seq · df_scales
- PARTS** SequenceFeature.get_df_parts → df_parts
- FEATURES** Part × Split × Scale · CPP.run → df_feat
- MODEL** TreeModel.fit · dPULearn.fit → feat_importance · labels_
- EXPLAIN** CPPPlot.feature_map · ShapModel → figure · feat_impact

Prediction Task Levels

task → setup

Residue AA_*
unit: sliding window (aa_window_size)
ref: non-site windows / shuffled background

positional

Domain DOM_*
unit: part-set jmd_n · tmd · jmd_c (from tmd_start / tmd_stop)
ref: labelled A vs B groups

both

Protein SEQ_*
unit: whole chain (composition)
ref: labelled groups / composition-matched background

compositional

Output types: classification · regression · ranking · explanation

Groups: 1: positives 0: negatives 0: reliable negatives 2: unlabeled
Label 0 is a curated **negative** in labelled data, or a dPULearn-inferred **reliable negative** drawn from the unlabeled (2) pool.

Sequence Anatomy

the TMD model

TMD Target Middle Domain — the central segment of interest (e.g. transmembrane domain); *variable length*.

JMD Juxta Middle Domain — the fixed-width flanks adjoining the TMD (jmd_n on the N-side, jmd_c on the C-side).

JMD-N TMD JMD-C
0 tmd_start tmd_stop len(seq)
JMD widths set globally: aa.options['jmd_n_len'] · ['jmd_c_len'].

AAanalysis · interpretable, sequence-based protein prediction

CPP Feature Concept

Part × Split × Scale

PART where on the sequence

tmd · jmd_n · jmd_c · tmd_jmd · jmd_n_tmd_n · tmd_c_jmd_c

SPLIT how to read the part

Segment — contiguous · Pattern — sparse pairs · PeriodicPattern — i, i+3/4

SCALE which physicochemical property

AAontology (~600 scales) · hydrophobicity · charge · helix propensity

TMD
Segment(1,4) A I I G L M V G G V V I
Pattern(N,1,4,8) ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■
PeriodicPattern ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■

Splitting maps parts (of various length) to fixed relative positions.

Simplified from Breimann25 (Suppl. Fig. 1C ↗)

TMD × Segment × hydrophobicity → membrane insertion
JMD × Pattern × net charge → electrostatic recognition
TMD × PeriodicPattern × helix → α-helical interface

CPP Strategies

via split_kws

Compositional ≈ sequence/protein-level

one whole-part average (composition-like, position-agnostic)

```
split_kws = sf.get_split_kws(
    split_types="Segment",
    n_split_max=1)
cpp = aa.CPP(df_parts=df_parts, split_kws=split_kws)
```

Positional ≈ residue/region-level

sub-segments and/or patterns resolved to positions

```
split_kws = sf.get_split_kws(
    split_types=["Segment", "Pattern", "PeriodicPattern"],
    n_split_max=5,
    steps_pattern=[3, 4],
    steps_periodicpattern=[3, 4])
cpp = aa.CPP(df_parts=df_parts, split_kws=split_kws)
```

Domain level uses both. → CPP strategies: see the CPP tutorial (docs).

See details in Breimann25 · Suppl. Fig. 1 ↗

Which Module Should I Use?

intent → module

Explore sequence patterns / composition

AAlogo

Sample reference windows (if negatives are missing)

AAWindowSampler

Reduce redundant amino acid scales

AAclust

Discover discriminative physicochemical features

CPP

Train with positives + unlabeled data

dPULearn

Train an interpretable classifier

TreeModel

Explain a prediction (per feature / sample)

ShapModel [pro]

Data & Preparation

datasets · scales · FASTA

Load benchmark sequences

load_dataset(name) → df_seq

Load AAontology scales

load_scales() → df_scales

Load precomputed features

load_features(name) → df_feat

Read / write FASTA

read_fasta(file) → df_seq

Cluster redundant homologs

filter_seq(df_seq) → df_clust [pro]

Sequence Analysis

logos · windows · motifs

Position-specific logo

AAlogo().get_df_logo(df_parts) → df_logo

Sample reference windows

AAWindowSampler().sample_*(df_seq)

Pairwise sequence similarity

comp_seq_sim(df_seq) [pro]

Scan motifs (FIMO / MEME)

scan_motif(df_seq, pwm) → df_hits [pro]

Feature Engineering

parts · CPP · scales

SequenceFeature → sf

sf = aa.SequenceFeature()

· split sequence into parts

sf.get_df_parts(df_seq) → df_parts

· assemble feature matrix X

sf.feature_matrix(df_feat, df_parts) → X

Discover discriminative features

CPP(df_parts).run(labels) → df_feat *

Sweep CPP configs (grid)

CPPGrid().run(...) · .eval() → ranked configs

Simplify → interpretable scales

CPP.simplify(df_feat, labels) → df_feat

Reduce redundant scales

AAclust().fit(X) [Wrapper]

Drop correlated features

NumericalFeature().filter_correlation(X)

Feature Preprocessing

one-hot · PLM · structure · PTM

Encode sequences (one-hot / int)

SequencePreprocessor().encode_*(seqs) → X

PLM embeddings v1.1

EmbeddingPreprocessor().encode(...) → dict_num

Structure / DSSP / PAE v1.1

StructurePreprocessor().encode_dssp(...) → dict_num [pro]

PTM / site annotations v1.1

AnnotationPreprocessor().encode(...) → dict_num [pro]

Combine sources v1.1

combine_dict_nums([...]) → dict_num

Numerical CPP v1.1

CPP(df_parts).run_num(dict_num_parts, labels) → df_feat

Modeling & Explainability

PU · classify · SHAP

Train with positives + unlabeled data

dPULearn().fit(X, labels) [Wrapper]

Train + RFE + MC importance

TreeModel().fit(X, labels) [Wrapper]

Per-feature / sample SHAP impact

ShapModel().fit(X, labels) [pro]

Metrics & Plotting

metrics · plots

Adjusted AUC (class imbalance)

comp_auc_adjusted(X, labels)

BIC score · KL divergence

comp_bic_score(X, labels) · comp_kld

Per-protein / detection (v1.1)

comp_per_protein_ap · comp_detection_metrics

Plot style, fonts & standalone legend

plot_settings(font_scale) · plot_legend(ax)

Protein Design

(to be extended)

mutations · design

In-silico point mutations v1.1

AAMut · AAMutPlot

Sequence-design libraries v1.1

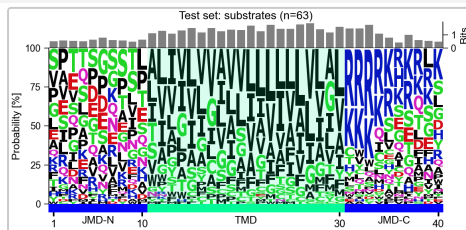
SeqMut · SeqMutPlot

aaanalysis.readthedocs.io · v1.1.0 · 2026-06

AAlogo — see the data

dataset at a glance

```
import numpy as np, matplotlib.pyplot as plt, aaanalysis as aa
df_seq = aa.load_dataset(name='DOM_GSEC') # γ-secretase
labels = list(df_seq['label']); df_scales = aa.load_scales()
sf = aa.SequenceFeature()
df_parts = sf.get_df_parts(df_seq=df_seq,
    list_parts=['tmd', 'jmd_n', 'jmd_c'])
aa.plot_settings(font_scale=0.7)
# aal kws builds df_logo + bits bar for you
aa.AAlogoPlot().single_logo(
    aal_kws=dict(df_parts=df_parts, labels=labels,
        label_test=1, tmd_len=20),
    name_data='Test set: substrates')
plt.tight_layout(); plt.show()
```



AAlogoPlot.single_logo · per-position enrichment

CPP — feature

top feature · test vs ref

```
# default parts + a redundancy-reduced set of 100 scales
df_parts = sf.get_df_parts(df_seq=df_seq)
df_scales = aa.AAclust().select_scales(
    df_scales=df_scales, n_clusters=100)
cpp = aa.CPP(df_parts=df_parts, df_scales=df_scales)
df_feat = cpp.run(labels=labels, n_filter=100)
X = sf.feature_matrix(df_feat['feature'], df_parts)
tm = aa.TreeModel(); tm.fit(X, labels=labels)
df_feat = tm.add_feat_importance(df_feat=df_feat, sort=True)
cpp_plot = aa.CPPPlot(); aa.plot_settings()
# distribution of the top feature (feat_rank=1 of the sorted
df_feat)
cpp_plot.feature(feature=df_feat, feat_rank=1, df_seq=df_seq,
    labels=labels, name_test='substrates', name_ref='non-subs.')
plt.tight_layout(); plt.show()
```

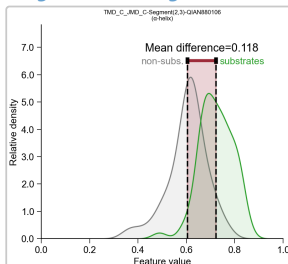
▼ figure below · left

CPP — ranking

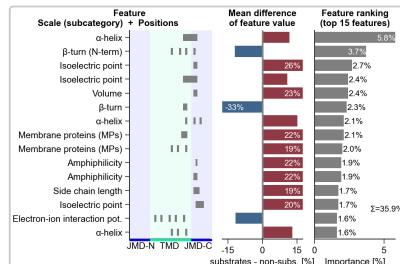
top features · effect + importance

```
# same df_feat — rank the top discriminative features
aa.plot_settings(font_scale=0.6)
cpp_plot.ranking(df_feat=df_feat, n_top=15, rank=True,
    name_test='substrates', name_ref='non-subs.')
plt.tight_layout(); plt.show()
```

▼ figure below · right



CPPPlot.feature · top feature

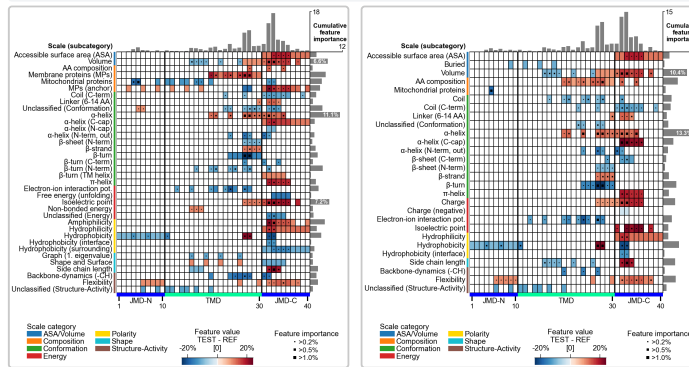


CPPPlot.ranking · top-15 features

CPP — feature map

group level · importance

```
# global Part × Split × Scale map — all AAontology scales
cpp_plot = aa.CPPPlot(); aa.plot_settings(font_scale=0.65)
cpp_plot.feature_map(df_feat=df_feat)
# CPP.simplify → fewer, interpretable correlated scales
df_feat = cpp.simplify(df_feat=df_feat, labels=labels)
cpp_plot.feature_map(df_feat=df_feat)
plt.tight_layout(); plt.show()
```



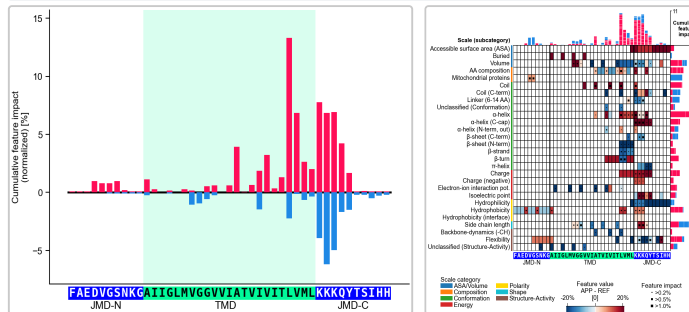
CPPPlot.feature_map · all scales

CPPPlot.feature_map · simplified

ShapModel — explain a prediction

sample level · [pro]

```
# per-sample SHAP — APP's soft label (0.6), keyed by entry
sm = aa.ShapModel()
sm.fit(X, labels=labels, df_seq=df_seq,
    fuzzy_labels={'P05067': 0.6})
df_feat = sm.add_feat_impact(df_feat=df_feat, df_seq=df_seq,
    samples='P05067', names='APP')
args_seq = sf.get_args_seq(df_seq=df_seq, sample='P05067')
ka = dict(col_imp='feat_impact APP', shap_plot=True, **args_seq)
cpp_plot.profile(df_feat=df_feat, **ka)
# vmin/vmax=±21% → same colour scale as the global feature map
(comparable)
cpp_plot.feature_map(df_feat=df_feat, name_test='APP',
    vmin=-21, vmax=21, **ka)
plt.tight_layout(); plt.show()
```



CPPPlot.profile · SHAP

CPPPlot.feature_map · SHAP

See details in Breimann25 · Suppl. Fig. 10 ↗

AAclust — clusters

scale reduction · clustering

```
aac = aa.AAclust()
# pick a redundancy-reduced set of scales
aac.select_scales(df_scales, n_clusters=10)
aac.medoid_names_ # 10 reduced scales (labels_ also set)

aac_plot = aa.AAclustPlot()
aac_plot.centers(df_scales=df_scales, labels=aac.labels_)
plt.tight_layout(); plt.show()
```

AAclust also reduces redundant proteins (not just scales)
df_seq = aac.select_proteins(df_seq=df_seq, X=X)

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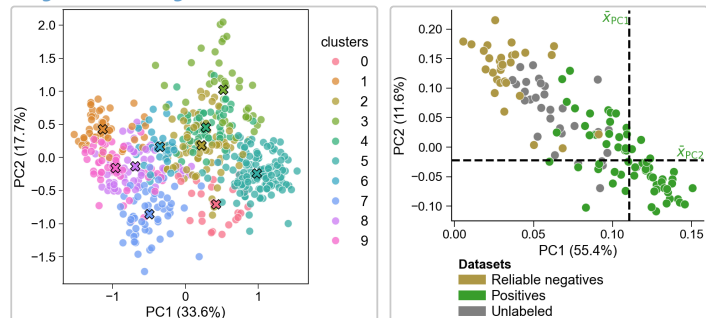
dPULearn — PCA

reliable negatives · PU learning

```
# DOM_GSEC ships 1/0 — treat 0 as the unlabeled pool (label_unl=0)
dpul = aa.dPULearn()
dpul.fit(X=X, labels=labels, label_unl=0, n_neg=31) # n_neg:
    reliable negatives to mine
df_pu = dpul.df_pu_ # out: 1 pos · 0 rel-neg · 2 unl

dpul_plot = aa.dPULearnPlot()
dpul_plot.pca(df_pu=df_pu, labels=dpul.labels_)
plt.tight_layout(); plt.show()
```

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AAclustPlot.centers · cluster scale profiles
See details in Breimann25 · Suppl. Fig. 3 ↗

dPULearnPlot.pca · reliable negatives

AAWindowSampler

build reference windows

```
# Reference windows around sites when you lack negatives:
aaws = aa.AAWindowSampler()
# SAME proteins · window 9 (odd) → PTM / single-residue site
df_same = aaws.sample_same_protein(df_seq, n=100, window_size=9)
# DIFFERENT proteins · window 10 (even) → cleavage bond
df_diff = aaws.sample_different_protein(df_seq, n=100,
    window_size=10)
# SYNTHETIC — AA-frequency priors (null background)
df_syn = aaws.sample_synthetic(df_seq, n=100,
    generator='global_freq')
```

Decision Guide

pick your setup

What are you predicting?
per residue / site → AA_* · odd/even window · parts = window
per domain / region → DOM_* · TMD model · parts = jmd_n-tmd:jmd_c
whole protein → SEQ_* · composition · whole chain

What labels do you have?
labeled 0 / 1 → CPP → ML model
positives + unlabeled (1 / 2) → CPP → dPULearn → ML model
no negatives at all → AAWindowSampler → CPP → ML model

What is your learning task?
classify → CPP → classifier (sklearn)
regress → get_labels_quantile / tiered → CPP → regression model
multi-class → get_labels_ovr / ovo → CPP → classifiers
cluster → AAclust

Which explainability do you need?
group level → CPP → TreeModel → CPPPlot → feature importance
per protein → CPP → ShapModel pro → CPPPlot → feature impact ↑ ↓

Gotchas

things that bite

- Labels: **1/0** = supervised (pos/neg). **dPULearn** takes 1/0 (label_unl=0) or 1/2; **n_neg** = reliable negatives to mine; output **1 · 0** (rel-neg) · **2** (unl).
- load_dataset(name, n=N)** returns **2N** rows (N per class) — count classes via df_seq['label'].
- Compositional vs positional is not a flag — it **emerges from split_kws**.
- Reproducibility: layered seeds — seed= ▶ random_state= ▶ options['random_state'] ▶ default.
- DOM_*** parts need tmd_start/tmd_stop in df_seq; **[pro]** features need `pip install 'aaanalysis[pro]'`.

Glossary

canonical vocabulary · CONTEXT.md

Feature (CPP) — (Part × Split × Scale) — the atomic, residue-grounded, interpretable unit of CPP.

Part — Named segment used as feature input: **tmd**, **jmd_n**, **jmd_c**, **tmd_jmd**, **jmd_n_tmd_n**, **tmd_c_jmd_c**.

TMD (Target Middle Domain) — The central *variable-length* sequence segment of interest, made comparable across samples by splitting. Called “transmembrane domain” in [Breimann25](#), but generalized here to any target segment.

JMD (Juxta Middle Domain) — The *fixed-length* flanking regions adjacent to the TMD: **jmd_n** (N-terminal side) and **jmd_c** (C-terminal side); called “juxtamembrane domain” in [Breimann25](#).

Split — How a scale is read across a part: Segment (contiguous), Pattern (sparse), PeriodicPattern (i, i+3/4).

Scale — AA (amino acid) → ℝ mapping. AAontology ships ~600 curated scales in two-level categories.

Design Principles

the AAanalysis way

- Explicit over implicit — DataFrames everywhere
- Wrappers (.fit / .predict / .eval) set trailing *_attributes after fit
- Biological interpretability is first-class
- Small-data robust and reproducible (layered seeds)

Key Data Objects

shapes & columns

df_seq entry · sequence · label · tmd_start · tmd_stop

df_parts one column per part: tmd · jmd_n · jmd_c · ...

df_feat feature · category · subcategory · scale_name · abs_auc · mean_dif · p_val · positions

X feature matrix (samples × features) from sf.feature_matrix

dict_num {entry: ndarray (L×D)} — numerical per-residue values

Class · abbr ↔ Plot Class

mirrored API

CLASS	ABBR	PLOT CLASS	KIND
SequencePreprocessor	sp	—	
EmbeddingPreprocessor	ep	—	
StructurePreprocessor pro	stp	—	
AnnotationPreprocessor pro	ap	—	
AAlogo	aal	AAlogoPlot	
AAWindowSampler	aaws	—	
SequenceFeature	sf	—	
NumericalFeature	nf	—	
AAclust	aac	AAclustPlot	Wrapper
CPP	cnp	CPPPlot	
dPULearn	dpu	dPULearnPlot	Wrapper
TreeModel	tm	—	Wrapper
ShapModel pro	sm	—	Wrapper
AAMut	aamut	AAMutPlot	
SeqMut	seqmut	SeqMutPlot	

AAontology — Two-level scale taxonomy; CPP uses its categories to organize and rank features.

CPP — Comparative Physicochemical Profiling — discovers ranked Part × Split × Scale features.

Test vs reference group — The A-vs-B contrast CPP profiles: a feature's mean_dif is test — reference (name_test / name_ref in CPPPlot).

Compositional vs positional — How split_kws resolves locality: a whole-part average (compositional) vs sub-region/position-resolved (positional).

Numerical CPP (pseudo-scale) v1.1.0 — CPP generalizes from AA→scale lookup to any per-residue tensor — PLM (protein language model) · structure (PDB file) · functional annotations (e.g. PTMs) — each a pseudo-scale via CPP.run_num.

aa.options

system-level settings

```
aa.options['random_state'] = 42
aa.options['verbose'] = True
aa.options['n_jobs'] = -1 # all cores (None = auto)
aa.options['allow_multiprocessing'] = True

# TMD model — JMD flank widths
aa.options['jmd_n_len'] = 10
aa.options['jmd_c_len'] = 10

# plot labels and system-level scales
aa.options['name_tmd'] = 'P5-P5' # e.g. cleavage site
aa.options['df_scales'] = my_scales
```

How to Cite

if you use AAanalysis

AAclust [Breimann24a]
Breimann & Frishman (2024a), AAclust: k-optimized clustering for selecting redundancy-reduced sets of amino acid scales
[Bioinformatics Advances](#) ↗

AAontology [Breimann24b]
Breimann et al. (2024b), AAontology: An ontology of amino acid scales for interpretable machine learning
[Journal of Molecular Biology](#) ↗

CPP & dPULearn [Breimann25]
Breimann & Kamp et al. (2025), Charting γ-secretase substrates by explainable AI
[Nature Communications](#) ↗

Feature importance vs impact — Two explainability axes: importance = unsigned, group-level (TreeModel); impact = signed, per-sample (ShapModel, shap_plot).

Reducing features — Four distinct ops: redundancy reduction (AAclust scales) · feature pruning · selection (RFE, recursive feature elimination) · simplification (CPP.simplify → interpretable scales).

PU learning (Positive-Unlabeled learning) — Training from labeled positives and unlabeled data only (no curated negatives); dPULearn infers reliable negatives from the unlabeled pool.

PU labels — dPULearn input: 1 = positive, 2 = unlabeled. Output: 1 / 0 (reliable-negative) / 2.

Wrapper class — sklearn-style class — .fit / .predict / .eval, sets trailing *_attributes after fit.

Plot class — *Plot mirror of an analytical class — same arguments, visualization only.